

RELIGIOUS EXPERIENCE: NATURE AND OBJECT

THREE-QUESTION METHOD → WILLIAM JAMES → RUDOLF OTTO AND THE → ADVAITA AND RADHAKRISHNAN → OBJECT MODELS → VERIDICALITY TESTS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g9 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00THREE-QUESTION METHOD

THREE-QUESTION METHODRELIGIOUS EXPERIENCE1 PHENOMENOLOGYWHAT IS IT LIKE?2 OBJECTWHAT IS EXPERIENCED—GOD, THE HOLY, BRAHMAN, EMPTINESS3 EPISTEMIC FORCEDOES SEEMING-TO-ENCOUNTER JUSTIFY BELIEF?

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

RELIGIOUS EXPERIENCE

- 1 PHENOMENOLOGY: what is it like?
- 2 OBJECT: what is experienced — God, the Holy, Brahman, emptiness, unity?

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

3 EPISTEMIC FORCE: does seeming-to-encounter justify belief?

- TYPES: mystical unity
- numinous encounter

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

prayer/worship revelatory vision

- non-dual awareness
- CONTROL: intensity and sincerity establish occurrence, not automatically veridical object.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Mystical experience is a mode of religious experience marked, for William James, primarily by ineffability and noetic quality.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Mystical experience is a mode of religious experience marked, for William James, primarily by ineffability and noetic quality.

01

STAGE 01WILLIAM JAMES

WILLIAM JAMESJAMES'S MARKS OF MYSTICAL EXPERIENCECANNOT BE ADEQUATELY STATEDNOETIC QUALITYFELT AS INSIGHT OR KNOWLEDGEUSUALLY BRIEFRECEIVED RATHER THAN FULLY PRODUCED BY WILL'FRUITS, NOT ROOTS'

JAMES'S MARKS OF MYSTICAL EXPERIENCE

INEFFABILITY: cannot be adequately stated

NOETIC QUALITY: felt as insight or knowledge

TRANSCIENCY: usually brief

PASSIVITY: received rather than fully produced by will

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

JAMES'S MARKS OF MYSTICAL EXPERIENCE

- INEFFABILITY: cannot be adequately stated
- NOETIC QUALITY: felt as insight or knowledge

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

TRANSCIENCY: usually brief

- PASSIVITY: received rather than fully produced by will
- 'fruits, not roots': assess transformation in life, not only origin theory authority is strongest for experience, not coercively

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

binding on outsiders plural experiences support openness, but diverse objects complicate doctrinal proof.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Veridicality asks whether a religious experience presents a real object rather than only a psychologically genuine state.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Veridicality asks whether a religious experience presents a real object rather than only a psychologically genuine state.

02

STAGE 02RUDOLF OTTO AND THE NUMINOUS

RUDOLF OTTO AND THE NUMINOUSTHE NUMINOUSMYSTERIUM TREMENDUM ET FASCINANS MYSTERIUMWHOLLY OTHER, BEYOND ORDINARY GRASP TREMENDUMAWE, MAJESTY, CREATURE-FEELING, DREAD FASCINANSATTRACTION, GRACE, COMPELLING VALUE

HOLY" INCLUDES NON-RATIONAL NUMINOUS DEPTH PLUS MORAL/RATIONAL DEVELOPMENTAUTOMATICALLY GOD

THE NUMINOUS = MYSTERIUM TREMENDUM ET FASCINANS mystery: wholly other, beyond ordinary grasp tremendum: awe

fascinans: attraction, grace, compelling value

"Holy" includes non-rational numinous depth plus moral/rational development

SACRED I= automatically God: an object, place or event may mediate the Holy objection: description

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

THE NUMINOUS = MYSTERIUM TREMENDUM ET FASCINANS mystery: wholly other, beyond ordinary grasp tremendum: awe, majesty, creature-feeling, dread

- fascinans: attraction, grace, compelling value

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

"Holy" includes non-rational numinous depth plus moral/rational development

- SACRED I= automatically God: an object, place or event may mediate the Holy objection: description can reify culturally

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

trained emotion into an external object.

- THE NUMINOUS = MYSTERIUM TREMENDUM ET FASCINANS mystery: wholly other, beyond ordinary grasp tremendum: awe, majesty, creature-feeling, dread

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: The numinous is Rudolf Otto's name for the non-rational experience of the Holy as mysterium tremendum et fascinans (a mystery evoking dread and attraction).

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: The numinous is Rudolf Otto's name for the non-rational experience of the Holy as mysterium tremendum et fascinans (a mystery evoking dread and attraction).

03

STAGE 03ADVAITA AND RADHAKRISHNAN

ADVAITA AND RADHAKRISHNANAPAROKṢĀNUBHŪTI IS IMMEDIATE KNOWLEDGE OF NON-DUAL BRAHMAN NOT SUBJECTLIBERATING KNOWLEDGEINTEGRAL INTUITION DISCLOSES SPIRITUAL UNITY AND GROUNDS TOLERANCE STRENGTHEXPERIENCE IS TRANSFORMATIVE AND NON-INFERENTIAL PRESSURE

INEFFABILITY VS DOCTRINAL DESCRIPTION; PRIVATE CERTAINTY VS PUBLIC ADJUDICATIONADVAITA INTERPRETATION MAY BE ONE CONCEPTUAL CONSTRUCTION AMONG RELIGIOUS

ADVAITA: aparokṣānubhūti is immediate knowledge of non-dual Brahman not subject seeing divine object

subject-object division is sublated śravaṇa → manana → nididhyāsana — liberating knowledge

RADHAKRISHNAN: integral intuition discloses spiritual unity and grounds tolerance strength: experience is transformative and non-inferential

private certainty vs public adjudication

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

ADVAITA: aparokṣānubhūti is immediate knowledge of non-dual Brahman not subject seeing divine object

- subject-object division is sublated śravaṇa → manana → nididhyāsana — liberating knowledge

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

RADHAKRISHNAN: integral intuition discloses spiritual unity and grounds tolerance strength: experience is transformative and non-inferential pressure: ineffability vs

- private certainty vs public adjudication

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

Advaita interpretation may be one conceptual construction among religious traditions.

- ADVAITA: aparokṣānubhūti is immediate knowledge of non-dual Brahman not subject seeing divine object

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Religious experience is an experience interpreted as disclosing or relating the subject to an ultimate, sacred or divine reality.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Religious experience is an experience interpreted as disclosing or relating the subject to an ultimate, sacred or divine reality.

04

STAGE 04OBJECT MODELS

OBJECT MODELSMODEL WHAT EXPERIENCE PRESENTS PERSONAL THEISM AN ADDRESSIVE "THOU,"OTTO NUMINOUS HOLYWHOLLY OTHERADVAITA NON-DUAL BRAHMAN; NO FINAL SUBJECT-OBJECT SPLITBUDDHISM EMPTINESS, CESSATION OR SUCHNESS WITHOUT CREATOR NATURALISM ALTERED

SAME PHENOMENOLOGICAL REPORT MAY UNDERDETERMINE ONTOLOGYOBJECT-CLAIM NEEDS INTERPRETATION BEYOND RAW IMMEDIACY.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

MODEL WHAT EXPERIENCE PRESENTS personal theism an addressive "Thou," grace, command, presence

- Otto numinous Holy / wholly other

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

Advaita non-dual Brahman; no final subject-object split

- Buddhism emptiness, cessation or suchness without creator naturalism altered brain/body state interpreted religiously

EVALUATION / TRAP

SAME phenomenological report may underdetermine ontology

- object-claim needs interpretation beyond raw immediacy.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: The sacred is the generic category of reality set apart as ultimately significant, while the Holy names the numinous value and presence emphasised by Otto.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: The sacred is the generic category of reality set apart as ultimately significant, while the Holy names the numinous value and presence emphasised by Otto.

05

STAGE 05VERIDICALITY TESTS

VERIDICALITY TESTSSWINBURNE PRINCIPLE OF CREDULITYACCEPT SEEMING APPEARANCE UNLESS DEFEATEDPRINCIPLE OF TESTIMONYGENERALLY TRUST REPORTS UNLESS THERE IS REASON NOT TOPRIOR IMPLAUSIBILITYUNRELIABLE SETTING POSITIVE CHECKSMORAL FRUIT

SWINBURNE PRINCIPLE OF CREDULITY: accept seeming appearance unless defeated

PRINCIPLE OF TESTIMONY: generally trust reports unless there is reason not to

DEFEATERS: drugs/pathology

prior implausibility

unreliable setting positive checks: coherence

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

SWINBURNE PRINCIPLE OF CREDULITY: accept seeming appearance unless defeated

- PRINCIPLE OF TESTIMONY: generally trust reports unless there is reason not to
- DEFEATERS: drugs/pathology
- prior implausibility

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

unreliable setting positive checks: coherence

- moral fruit
- intersubjective fit
- predictive/explanatory value

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

ALSTON: socially established doxastic practice may confer prima facie justification objection: incompatible religious practices cannot all validate exclusive

- objects unchanged.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Alston's perceptual model treats mystical perception as an experience in which God appears to be directly presented.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Alston's perceptual model treats mystical perception as an experience in which God appears to be directly presented.

06

STAGE 06CRITICISMS, REPLIES AND PUBLIC LIFE

CRITICISMS, REPLIES AND PUBLIC LIFESOCIAL CONSOLATIONNEURAL CORRELATE PLURALISMCONTRADICTIONARY INTERPRETATIONSNO COMMUNICABLE EVIDENCE REPLIESCAUSAL EXPLANATION DOES NOT EQUAL DEBUNKING; ALL PERCEPTION HAS

FRUITS AND DISCIPLINED PRACTICES MAY DISTINGUISH MATURE EXPERIENCE FROMPETITION, GRATITUDE, SURRENDER, CONTEMPLATION PUBLIC USE MUST BE MODEST

FREUD: wish-fulfilment

MARX: social consolation

neuroscience: neural correlate pluralism: contradictory interpretations

ineffability: no communicable evidence replies: causal explanation does not equal debunking; all perception has neural

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

FREUD: wish-fulfilment

- MARX: social consolation

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

neuroscience: neural correlate pluralism: contradictory interpretations

- ineffability: no communicable evidence replies: causal explanation does not equal debunking; all perception has neural correlates

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

fruits and disciplined practices may distinguish mature experience from fantasy prayer/worship test object-relations: petition, gratitude, surrender, contemplation public

- use must be modest: experience may justify commitment without authorising coercion.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Prayer is communicative address to the ultimate, whereas worship is the acknowledgement and enactment of supreme worth.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Prayer is communicative address to the ultimate, whereas worship is the acknowledgement and enactment of supreme worth.

07

STAGE 07PYQ ANSWER SPINE

PYQ ANSWER SPINEDEFINE TYPEDESCRIBE PHENOMENOLOGY WITH JAMES/OTTOSPECIFY CLAIMED OBJECTDISTINGUISH EXPERIENCE FROM INTERPRETATIONAPPLY CREDULITY/TESTIMONY AND DEFEATERSCOMPARE ADVAITA/THEISM/BUDDHISMSTRONGEST NATURALIST OR PLURALIST OBJECTION

DEFINE type → describe phenomenology with James/Otto → specify claimed object

distinguish experience from interpretation → apply credulity/testimony and defeaters

compare Advaita/theism/Buddhism → strongest naturalist or pluralist objection

reply → qualified public verdict

CLOSE: religious experience is significant evidence within a life and practice, but its object is

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

DEFINE type → describe phenomenology with James/Otto → specify claimed object

- distinguish experience from interpretation → apply credulity/testimony and defeaters

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

compare Advaita/theism/Buddhism → strongest naturalist or pluralist objection

- reply → qualified public verdict

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

CLOSE: religious experience is significant evidence within a life and practice, but its object is not read straight off the feeling

- interpretation and defeater control remain.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Public discourse requires private religious experience to be translated into claims assessable through shared reasons and observable consequences.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Public discourse requires private religious experience to be translated into claims assessable through shared reasons and observable consequences.

E

EXTRASUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENTADVANCED-DOSSIER RECONCILIATION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]DOCTRINE STATEMENTMYSTICAL STATES ARE MARKED BY INEFFABILITY AND NOETIC QUALITYTHEIR AUTHORITY IS STRONGEST FOR THE SUBJECT AND TESTED

JAMES GATHERS FIRST-PERSON REPORTS, IDENTIFIES RECURRENT PHENOMENOLOGICAL FEATURES, ANDPRESUPPOSITION, CAUTIONFIRST-PERSON TESTIMONY IS LEGITIMATE DATA AND PRAGMATIC TRANSFORMATION IS

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

Advanced-dossier reconciliation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

- Doctrine statement.
- Mystical states are marked by ineffability and noetic quality, with transiency and passivity as usual additional marks
- their authority is strongest for the subject and tested pragmatically by fruits.

ADVANCED OBJECTION

Argument.

- James gathers first-person reports, identifies recurrent phenomenological features, and refuses to reduce their value to pathological origins because
- Presupposition. CAUTION: First-person testimony is legitimate data and pragmatic transformation is evidentially relevant.
- Distinction. Noetic quality means experienced insight, not independently demonstrated knowledge.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

Canonical example. Conversion reorganises a divided self and is assessed through enduring moral integration.

- Objection — reply.
- CAUTION: Private certainty cannot establish a public object.
- James restricts coercive authority: the experience may rationally authorise the experienter without binding outsiders.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels